DEV 140 · DISCUSSION 5 · ACCESSIBILITY

Make Your Page Work for Everyone

Practice on the sourdough page, then run WAVE on your own project. Find 3 issues, explain who they affect, fix them, and write a short reflection.

Same folder, same repo, same routine. WAVE marks accessibility problems right on your page. Use the **browser extension**: the wave.webaim.org website can't see a page that's only on your computer. Mac: `Cmd` for `Ctrl`.

YOUR FINISHED LINK

`https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/dev-140-yourname-f26/discussion-2/`

your GitHub account | your class repo | your project folder

```
Desktop\DEV 140 - Web Development\
└── Discussions\              ← open this in VS Code (= your repo)
    ├── discussion-2\         ← your project page (the homework)
    │   ├── index.html        ← most fixes go here (steps 9–12)
    │   └── style.css         ← contrast + text fixes go here
    ├── discussion-3\
    ├── discussion-4\
    └── discussion-5\         ← NEW: in-class practice (step 2)
        ├── index.html        ← from GitHub (step 4)
        ├── style.css         ← from GitHub (step 4)
        └── sourdough-loaf.svg ← copied (step 3)
```

Before you start ☐ WAVE extension from `wave.webaim.org/extension` ☐ VS Code on `Discussions` ☐ Read page 2

READING WAVE

THE ICONS what each color means

ICON	WAVE CALLS IT	WHAT TO DO
✕	**Errors**	Real problems. Fix these first.
◐	**Contrast Errors**	Text too faint to read. Fix these too.
!	**Alerts**	Maybe a problem. Look at it and decide.
✓	**Features**	Good things, like alt text. Keep them.
≡	**Structure / ARIA**	Headings, lists, landmarks. Info only.

THE SIDEBAR TABS where to find what the homework asks for

Summary	The totals. Write down your starting numbers.
Details	Every issue by **name**. Click one to jump to the **element** on the page.
Reference	WAVE explains what it is, **why it matters**, and how to fix it.
Contrast	Shows the ratio for faint text, with a slider to try darker colors.
Code `</>`	Shows the HTML for the issue you clicked.

COMMON ISSUES AND THEIR FIXES most are one line

WAVE SAYS	WHO IT AFFECTS	THE FIX
◐ Very low contrast	Low vision; phones in sunlight	Darker color. Needs **4.5 : 1**+
✕ Missing alternative text	Screen readers say only "image"	`alt="..."` describing it
✕ Missing form label	Screen readers say only "edit text"	`<label for="x">` + `id="x"`
✕ Empty link / button	Screen readers say only "link"	Words inside, or `aria-label`
✕ Language missing	Screen readers may pick the wrong voice	`<html lang="en">`
! Very small text	Anyone who can't zoom easily	`0.875rem` or bigger
! Justified text	Readers with dyslexia	`text-align: left;`
! Skipped heading level	Screen readers that jump by heading	`h2` → `h3`, not → `h4`
! Suspicious link text	Anyone scanning the links	Say where it goes

Stuck? **a11y.coffee/quick-wins** explains the six most common errors.

GET THE PRACTICE FILES

1. **Open the class folder on GitHub.**
   Click **discussion-5 on GitHub**. You'll see `index.html` and `style.css`.
2. **Make your `discussion-5` folder**
   inside `Discussions`, next to `discussion-4`.
3. **Copy the image.**
   Copy `sourdough-loaf.svg` from your `discussion-4` folder into `discussion-5`.
4. **Paste both files.**
   For each file: open it on GitHub → **Copy raw file**. In VS Code, **New File** in `discussion-5` with the same name, `Ctrl`+`V`, save.

CODE ALONG

5. **Open with Live Server.**
   Right-click `discussion-5/index.html` → **Open with Live Server**. Does anything look broken?
6. **Run WAVE.**
   Click the WAVE icon in your browser toolbar. Note your Errors and Contrast Errors.
7. **Example 1: HTML fixes.**
   FIX 1–2 (listed at the top of `style.css`): alt text on the loaf image, and `lang="en"`.
8. **Example 2: CSS fixes.**
   FIX 3–4: the faint tagline and the tiny fine print. Click the WAVE icon again after *every* fix.

YOUR PROJECT PAGE

9. **Run WAVE on your own page.**
   Open it with Live Server and click the WAVE icon.
10. **Write down 3 issues.**
    Use the template on page 2: the name, the element, and what WAVE said.
11. **Fix them, and check again.**
    Save, refresh, click the WAVE icon. Each fixed icon should be gone.
12. **Commit and sync.**
    `Ctrl`+`Shift`+`G`, type `Fix accessibility issues`, **Commit**, then **Sync Changes**.
13. **Submit.**
    Your repo URL, plus your reflection pasted in the text box.

WAVE can't check everything.
It can tell you alt text is *missing*, but not whether it's *good*: `alt="image"` is useless. After WAVE, press `Tab` through your page. Can you always see where you are, and reach every link?

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Accessibility Homework Checklist

Run WAVE on **your own project**, not the sourdough page. Submit your updated GitHub repo URL and paste your reflection in the text box.

REQUIREMENT	WHAT TO INCLUDE	COMMON MISTAKE
1. Document at least 3 issues	For each one: the **issue name** (exactly as WAVE says it), the **element** it's on, and **what WAVE reported**.	"WAVE found a contrast error." Which text? Name the element, like "the tagline under my `h1`".
2. Explain why each one matters	Who has trouble because of it, and what happens to them? Name a real person and a real experience.	"Because it's an accessibility rule." Say who it affects and what they experience.
3. Fix all 3 issues	Change your code, push it, and run WAVE again. Those icons should be gone.	Fixing it locally but not committing and syncing. The grader only sees what's on GitHub.
4. 150–200 word reflection	What you **learned**: what surprised you, what changed in how you think about your page.	A list of fixes ("I added alt text. I added a label."). That's requirement 1, not a reflection.

DOCUMENT EACH ISSUE LIKE THIS

An example from the sourdough page. Copy this layout for each of your 3 issues.

ISSUE	✕ Missing alternative text
ELEMENT	The loaf photo in the "Why I Started Baking Sourdough" section: `<img src="sourdough-loaf.svg">`
WAVE REPORTED	"Image alternative text is not present."
WHY IT MATTERS	A blind visitor using a screen reader hears "image" or the file name, and misses the whole point of the picture: this is the first loaf that actually rose.
THE FIX	Added `alt="A round, golden-brown sourdough loaf with a cross-shaped score…"`. Re-ran WAVE: the red icon is now a green alt-text icon.

WRITING THE REFLECTION

Pick one or two of these questions and answer them honestly. You don't need to answer them all.

- Which issue would you **never have noticed** without WAVE? Why not?
- Who did you picture using your page before today? Who do you picture now?
- What can WAVE **not** tell you? What did you find when you pressed `Tab` through your page?
- What will you do **differently** when you build your next page?

A LIST OF FIXES
"I fixed the contrast on my footer and added alt text to two images."

A REFLECTION
"My footer looked fine on my laptop, so I never thought of someone reading it on a phone outside…"

Count your words before you submit: 150 to 200.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

YOU SEE	DO THIS
wave.webaim.org can't reach my page	Your page is only on your computer. Use the WAVE **extension**, or paste your GitHub Pages link instead.
The extension does nothing	You opened the file by double-clicking it. Use **Open with Live Server** instead.
I fixed it, but WAVE still shows it	Save, hard refresh with `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `R`, then click the WAVE icon again. WAVE doesn't update by itself.
Still "Missing form label"	The label's `for` must **exactly** match the input's `id`. Capital letters count.
Still "Very low contrast"	Check WAVE's **Contrast** tab for the two colors it compares. On a button, change the background, not just the text.
"Empty link" on an icon	Social icons and arrows need words. Add text inside the link, or `aria-label="Instagram"`.
WAVE shows 0 errors on my page	Nice! Look at the yellow **Alerts** and Contrast Errors. Ask your instructor which ones count.
Works locally, not on GitHub	Commit and sync, wait for the green ✓ in **Actions**, then hard refresh your live link.